



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

tato* dhanuḥ puṣpamayam* grhītvā |
(śarān jagan+moha+Cśarāṃs* tathā moha+)karāṃś* ca pañca |
so* aśva+ttha+mūlam* sa+suto* abhyagacchad* |
a+svāsthya+kārī manasaḥ prajānām || 13.7 |
atha prasāntam* munim āsana+stham* |
pāram* titīṣum* bhava+sāgarasya |
viśajya savyam* karam āyudha+agre |
(krīḍan Ckrīḍaṇ*)śareṇa*idam uvāca mārāḥ || 13.8 |

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 13, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Buddhacarita passage introduces us to a pivotal moment in Siddhartha's journey: the confrontation with Mara, the personification of temptation and illusion. Mara approaches Siddhartha, now seated at the foot of the Bodhi tree, poised on the brink of enlightenment. Mara doesn't come with brute force, but with subtle weaponry: a bow fashioned from flowers and arrows tipped with desire, delusion, and discontent, all designed to stir unease and pull Siddhartha away from his unwavering focus. He aims to disrupt the peace Siddhartha embodies, a peace that threatens Mara's dominion over the minds of humanity. Mara sees Siddhartha as a threat, a beacon of liberation that could free others from his grasp.

This encounter isn't just a historical event; it's a symbolic representation of the internal battles we all face. Mara's flowery arrows symbolize the seductive nature of worldly pleasures and distractions. They are the fleeting joys that promise happiness but ultimately lead to dissatisfaction and suffering. In your own life, these could manifest as the relentless pursuit of material possessions, the craving for validation from others, or the addiction to instant gratification through technology. These desires, like Mara's arrows, can wound your peace of mind and divert you from your true path.

Siddhartha's stillness and unwavering resolve represent the power of mindfulness and detachment. He recognizes Mara's tricks for what they are: illusions designed to keep him trapped in the cycle of suffering. By staying present and grounded in his meditation, he doesn't succumb to the allure of these temptations. You too can cultivate this inner strength by practicing mindfulness, observing your thoughts and emotions without judgment, and recognizing the impermanent nature of all things. By understanding the true source of lasting happiness lies within, you can dismantle Mara's influence in your life. The path to enlightenment, like Siddhartha's journey, is paved with challenges, but by cultivating awareness, you can overcome the seductive power of illusion and discover the unwavering peace within.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What "flowery arrows" are currently distracting you from your inner peace, and how can you cultivate detachment from these illusions?